Unit 2

Ideation

3 Slibraries · 15 framework sheets

SLIBRARY 4 · Divergence Methods — 5 sheets

1. Crazy 8s
2. SCAMPER
3. Brainwriting 6-3-5
4. Analogies & Random Stimulus
5. Worst Possible Ideas

SLIBRARY 5 · Convergence Toolkit — 5 sheets

1. Dot Voting
2. NUF Test
3. Impact-Effort Matrix
4. 2×2 Decision Matrix
5. How-Now-Wow

SLIBRARY 6 · Creative Sprints — 5 sheets

1. Google Design Sprint
2. GV Sprint 2.0
3. Idea Speed-Dating
4. Lightning Decision Jam
5. Sprint Retrospective

Crazy 8s

SLIBRARY 4 · SHEET 1 / 5

Eight sketches in eight minutes — quantity forces fluency

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Crazy 8s is a divergence-pressure method in which each participant folds a sheet into eight panels and sketches one distinct idea per panel against an eight-minute timer — exactly one minute per panel. The forced volume defeats the inner critic, generates ideas fast, and surfaces unconventional directions that careful deliberation edits out. Quantity is engineered to produce quality through the law of divergence (Knapp, Zeratsky and Kowitz, 2016).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Codified by Jake Knapp at Google Ventures (now GV) as a core element of the Design Sprint, published in *Sprint* (Knapp, Zeratsky and Kowitz, 2016). Builds on Edward de Bono's lateral-thinking exercises and Linus Pauling's quantity-of-ideas heuristic.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Sprint teams routinely got stuck polishing the first idea each person produced — second-idea uplift was being lost. Knapp engineered a structure where polishing was impossible and each team-member's unspoken second, fifth and eighth ideas became visible artefacts.

FIGURE 1 · EIGHT PANELS

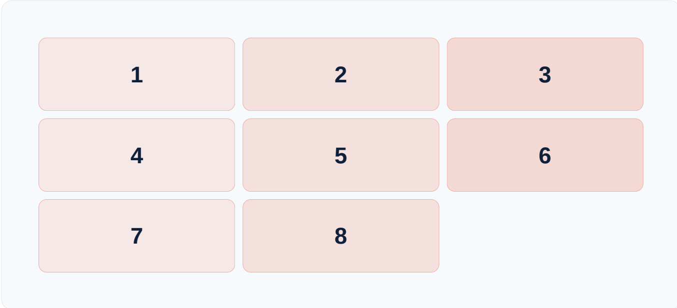

Figure 1. Eight folded panels × eight minutes = one minute per idea. The constraint is the design.

HOW IT IS USED

Each participant folds an A4 sheet into eight panels, sketches one idea per panel against a one-minute timer. The team then dot-votes across all sheets to surface promising directions.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use as the divergence step in any Design Sprint, mid-workshop when energy flags, and when a team has converged too quickly on a single idea before generating real alternatives.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Sprint facilitators, product managers, design researchers, and any cross-functional team needing rapid, individual idea generation in a low-stakes format.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Osborn's (1953) brainstorming was group-verbal and prone to social loafing, and de Bono's (1985) Six Hats organised group thinking serially, Crazy 8s' contribution is the per-person, time-boxed, sketch-based forcing function. Building on Pauling's quantity heuristic, it makes second-idea uplift inevitable.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

- SCAMPER · Slibrary 4
- Brainwriting 6-3-5 · Slibrary 4
- Google Design Sprint · Slibrary 6
- How Might We (HMW) · Slibrary 3

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Knapp, J., Zeratsky, J. and Kowitz, B. (2016) *Sprint: How to Solve Big Problems and Test New Ideas in Just Five Days*. New York: Simon & Schuster.
Osborn, A.F. (1953) *Applied Imagination*. New York: Scribner.
de Bono, E. (1985) *Six Thinking Hats*. London: Penguin.
Gray, D., Brown, S. and Macanufo, J. (2010) *Gamestorming*. Sebastopol, CA: O'Reilly.

SCAMPER

SLIBRARY 4 · SHEET 2 / 5

Substitute · Combine · Adapt · Modify · Put to other use · Eliminate · Reverse

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

SCAMPER is a question-based divergence checklist that systematically applies seven transformative verbs to an existing product, service or idea: *Substitute, Combine, Adapt, Modify, Put to other use, Eliminate, Reverse*. Each verb forces a direction a free-form brainstorm misses. Originally a children's creativity exercise, SCAMPER became a cornerstone of corporate ideation training (Eberle, 1971; Michalko, 2006).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Bob Eberle, an educator, codified SCAMPER in 1971 as a memorable acronym for Alex Osborn's earlier 73-question brainstorming checklist (1953). Popularised through Michael Michalko's *Thinkertoys* (2006) and adopted into MBA innovation curricula globally.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Open-ended brainstorming defaulted to additive features — the most accessible direction. SCAMPER's seven prompts force the team into directions otherwise overlooked (substitution, elimination, reversal), preventing convergence-too-soon.

FIGURE 1 · SEVEN VERBS

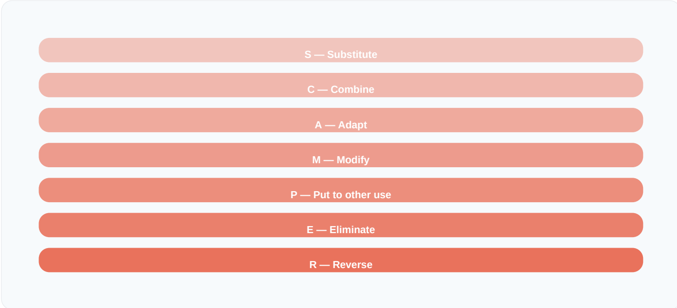

Figure 1. The seven verbs are walked in order; under-used verbs (eliminate, reverse) typically yield the highest-novelty options.

HOW IT IS USED

Take a current product or idea. Walk the SCAMPER list in order, generating at least three options per verb. Score and dot-vote at the end; under-used verbs typically yield highest novelty.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use when iterating on an existing product, when a team is stuck in additive ideation, in product-management workshops, and as a structured warm-up.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product managers, marketing teams, R&D; leads, and innovation facilitators training teams in structured creativity. Particularly useful for teams who find pure brainstorming intimidating.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Osborn's (1953) original 73-question list was unwieldy, Eberle's contribution was the memorable seven-letter acronym that allowed practitioners to internalise it. Building on Polya's (1945) heuristic-question tradition, SCAMPER made systematic creativity portable.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

- Crazy 8s · Slibrary 4
- Worst Possible Ideas · Slibrary 4
- Analogies & Random Stimulus · Slibrary 4
- How Might We (HMW) · Slibrary 3

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Eberle, B. (1971) *SCAMPER: Games for Imagination Development*. Buffalo, NY: D.O.K. Publishers.
Michalko, M. (2006) *Thinkertoys: A Handbook of Creative-Thinking Techniques*. 2nd edn. Berkeley: Ten Speed Press.
Osborn, A.F. (1953) *Applied Imagination*. New York: Scribner.
Polya, G. (1945) *How to Solve It*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.

Brainwriting 6-3-5

SLIBRARY 4 · SHEET 3 / 5

Six people × three ideas × five minutes — silent, written, no group-think

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Brainwriting 6-3-5 is a structured silent-ideation method: six participants each write three ideas in five minutes on a sheet, then pass it to the next person, who builds three more — repeated six times. The mechanic generates 108 ideas (6×3×6) in thirty minutes, with no anchoring on whoever speaks first and no social loafing. Originated as *Methode 635* at the Battelle Institute (Rohrbach, 1969).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Bernd Rohrbach, a German marketing professional at the Battelle Institute Frankfurt, in 1968. Published as *Methode 635* in *Absatzwirtschaft* (Rohrbach, 1969). Migrated to English-language innovation literature through VanGundy (1984) and Litcanu et al. (2015).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Traditional brainstorming amplified extroverts' early ideas as anchors and silenced introverts. A silent, written, peer-built protocol produced both higher idea volume and higher diversity — measurably better than verbal brainstorming in Rohrbach's trials.

FIGURE 1 · 6-3-5 MECHANIC

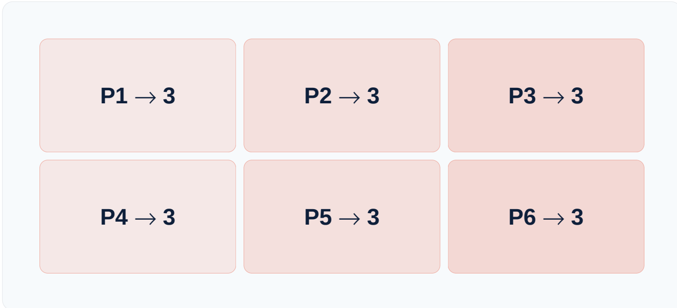

Figure 1. Six passes × three ideas × five minutes = 108 ideas in thirty minutes, with no verbal anchoring.

HOW IT IS USED

Six participants sit at a table with one sheet each (3-column × 6-row grid). Five minutes per round; in each round, write three ideas, then pass clockwise. After six rounds, the team has 108 ideas across all sheets.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use when teams are introverted or hierarchical, when a few voices dominate verbal brainstorms, in early-stage ideation, and when auditable per-person idea contribution is needed.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Innovation facilitators, R&D; and engineering teams, multilingual or cross-cultural workshops, and academic settings where verbal participation is unevenly distributed.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Osborn's (1953) brainstorming was verbal and synchronous, Brainwriting 6-3-5's contribution was the silent, written, peer-built mechanic. Building on Delphi-method (Dalkey, 1969) traditions of asynchronous expert input, it preserves anonymity at the moment of generation while inviting build-on collaboration.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Crazy 8s · Slibrary 4 | SCAMPER · Slibrary 4 | Dot Voting · Slibrary 5 | How Might We (HMW) · Slibrary 3

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Rohrbach, B. (1969) 'Kreativ nach Regeln — Methode 635', *Absatzwirtschaft*, 12(19), pp. 73–75.

VanGundy, A.B. (1984) 'Brainwriting for New Product Ideas', *Journal of Consumer Marketing*, 1(2), pp. 67–74.

Litcanu, M., Prostean, O., Oros, C. and Mnerie, A.V. (2015) 'Brain-Writing vs. Brainstorming', *Procedia – Social and Behavioral Sciences*, 191, pp. 387–390.

Dalkey, N.C. (1969) *The Delphi Method*. Santa Monica: RAND.

Analogies & Random Stimulus

SLIBRARY 4 · SHEET 4 / 5

Force-fit unrelated domains to unlock unseen frames

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Analogical thinking and random-stimulus methods deliberately import structure from a distant domain to disrupt habitual frames. Practitioners pose *How does industry X solve problem Y?* or roll a random word into the brief. The forced incongruity surfaces frames domain insiders cannot see directly, exploiting the cognitive principle that creativity arises at the boundary between dissimilar conceptual structures (Gentner, 1983; de Bono, 1992).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Edward de Bono codified random-input methods in *Serious Creativity* (1992); Dedre Gentner's (1983) structure-mapping theory of analogy provided cognitive grounding. William Gordon's *Synectics* (1961) operationalised analogy as a group method.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Domain experts develop deep familiarity that helps execution but limits ideation — they cannot see the water they swim in. Importing structure from an unrelated domain forces the expert's frame to flex, surfacing options invisible from inside the domain.

FIGURE 1 · CROSS-DOMAIN TRANSFER

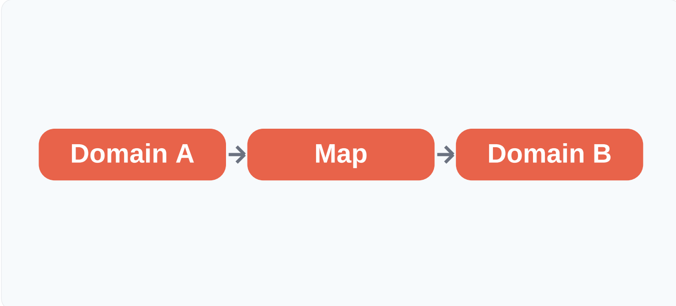

Figure 1. Structure imported from an unrelated domain disrupts the expert's habitual frame and surfaces new options.

HOW IT IS USED

Pick (or randomly select) an unrelated domain. Map its key structures onto the current problem: *If we redesigned this like a hospital ER, what would change?* Document insights even where the analogy partially breaks down.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use when a team is stuck in domain conventions, when a problem has resisted internal solutions, in cross-industry consulting, and as a generative warm-up.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Strategy consultants, R&D; teams, innovation facilitators, and academic researchers. Especially powerful with multidisciplinary teams that bring multiple natural analogies.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Compared with Osborn's (1953) free-association brainstorming and de Bono's (1985) Six Hats role-playing, the analogical contribution is structured cross-domain transfer. Gentner's (1983) structure-mapping theory gave it cognitive legitimacy; Gordon's (1961) Synectics gave it group methodology.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

SCAMPER · Slibrary 4 | Worst Possible Ideas · Slibrary 4 | Crazy 8s · Slibrary 4 | How Might We (HMW) · Slibrary 3

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

de Bono, E. (1992) *Serious Creativity*. New York: HarperBusiness.

Gentner, D. (1983) 'Structure-Mapping: A Theoretical Framework for Analogy', *Cognitive Science*, 7(2), pp. 155–170.

Gordon, W.J.J. (1961) *Synectics: The Development of Creative Capacity*. New York: Harper & Row.

Hofstadter, D.R. and Sander, E. (2013) *Surfaces and Essences*. New York: Basic Books.

Worst Possible Ideas

SLIBRARY 4 · SHEET 5 / 5

Generate terrible ideas — the inversion liberates the real ones

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Worst Possible Ideas is an inversion technique: the team is asked to generate the most terrible, offensive or counter-productive solutions imaginable. Removing the pressure to be "good" releases inhibition, energises the room, and — through the inverse-mapping that follows — surfaces the real ideas being suppressed. Constraining toward badness is psychologically far easier than reaching for goodness (Lewrick, Link and Leifer, 2018).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

A standard d.school and IDEO facilitation move, codified in *The Design Thinking Playbook* (Lewrick, Link and Leifer, 2018) and Liedtka and Ogilvie's *Designing for Growth* (2011). Roots in psychodrama and improv-theatre warm-up traditions.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Early ideation rounds were inhibited by the implicit demand for "good" ideas. Inverting the prompt removed inhibition, generated immediate energy, and — once inverted — produced higher-quality real ideas than direct ideation.

FIGURE 1 · INVERT & HARVEST

Worst	Inverted real idea
Hidden checkout	One-click checkout
Insult users	Surprise & delight
Slowest possible	Fastest path
Hide all features	Progressive disclosure

Figure 1. Each terrible idea, inverted, surfaces the real idea inhibition had suppressed.

HOW IT IS USED

Ask the team to generate the worst possible solutions. Encourage offence, absurdity and impossibility. After 10 minutes, invert each one — "what is the opposite?" — and harvest the real ideas hidden in the inversions.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use as an opening warm-up, when a team is overly self-critical, when leadership is in the room and inhibits candour, and when ideation has stalled.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Workshop facilitators, design coaches, MBA innovation classes, and cross-cultural teams where direct creative exposure feels socially risky.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Osborn's (1953) defer-judgement rule asked participants to suspend criticism, Worst Possible Ideas *inverts the criterion* entirely. Building on Karl Duncker's (1945) functional-fixedness experiments, the method exploits the psychological asymmetry: inhibition relaxes faster when the goal is reversed than when judgement is merely deferred.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

SCAMPER · Slibrary 4 | Crazy 8s · Slibrary 4 | Brainwriting 6-3-5 · Slibrary 4 | Pre-Mortem · Slibrary 11

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Lewrick, M., Link, P. and Leifer, L. (2018) *The Design Thinking Playbook*. Hoboken: Wiley.
Liedtka, J. and Ogilvie, T. (2011) *Designing for Growth*. New York: Columbia Business School Publishing.
Duncker, K. (1945) 'On Problem-Solving', *Psychological Monographs*, 58(5), pp. i–113.
Gray, D., Brown, S. and Macanufo, J. (2010) *Gamestorming*. Sebastopol, CA: O'Reilly.

Dot Voting

SLIBRARY 5 · SHEET 1 / 5

Every participant gets N dots — distribute across the wall

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Dot voting is a fast distributed-decision technique in which each participant receives a fixed number of stickers (typically 3–5) and places them on options they support. Distribution patterns matter: clusters reveal consensus, spread reveals genuine ambiguity, outliers reveal minority views. The method is fast (under five minutes), legible (everyone sees the result), and resistant to seniority anchoring (Gray, Brown and Macanufo, 2010).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Originated in 1970s participatory-planning practice (notably Lawrence Halprin's RSVP Cycles), codified in agile and design facilitation through Gray, Brown and Macanufo's *Gamestorming* (2010), and adopted into the Stanford d.school's tool stack.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Group convergence by discussion was slow, prone to anchoring on the loudest voice, and produced decisions team members did not own. Dot voting compressed convergence to minutes, made every voice equal, and externalised the result.

FIGURE 1 · VOTE PATTERNS

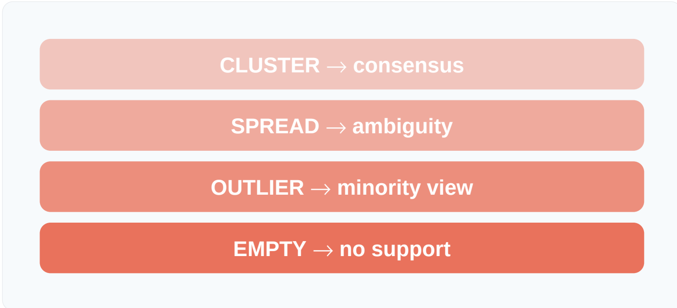

Figure 1. The pattern, not just the count, carries the signal: clusters confirm, spreads warn.

HOW IT IS USED

After idea generation, give each participant a fixed dot allowance. Ask them to place dots on options they support (multiple on one option allowed unless restricted). Count and discuss outliers and clusters before deciding.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use after any divergent ideation, in workshop convergence steps, in stakeholder prioritisation, and at the end of brainstorms to triage what to take forward.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Workshop facilitators, agile teams (sprint planning), product managers, and any team with more options than can be pursued. Useful in mixed-seniority groups.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Robert's Rules majority voting required formal motions and traditional Delphi methods (Dalkey, 1969) ran asynchronously over weeks, dot voting's contribution is the public, simultaneous, fast-feedback ritual. Building on participatory-planning traditions, it operationalises minority-protected convergence in minutes.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

NUF Test · Slibrary 5 | Impact-Effort Matrix · Slibrary 5 | How-Now-Wow · Slibrary 5 | 2×2 Decision Matrix · Slibrary 5

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Gray, D., Brown, S. and Macanufo, J. (2010) *Gamestorming*. Sebastopol: O'Reilly.
Knapp, J., Zeratsky, J. and Kowitz, B. (2016) *Sprint*. New York: Simon & Schuster.
Halprin, L. (1969) *The RSVP Cycles*. New York: Braziller.
Plattner, H. (2010) *Bootcamp Bootleg*. Stanford: Hasso Plattner Institute of Design.

NUF Test

SLIBRARY 5 · SHEET 2 / 5

Novel · Useful · Feasible — score each idea on three axes

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The NUF Test scores each candidate idea on three independent criteria: Novel (sufficiently differentiated), Useful (genuinely solves the user's problem), and Feasible (deliverable within constraints). Each criterion is scored 1–10, and the three scores are weighted by context — innovation portfolios privilege novelty, execution portfolios privilege feasibility. The discipline of scoring across all three blocks the common failure of optimising one and shipping (Sloane, 2017).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Paul Sloane, innovation consultant and author, codified the NUF Test in *The Leader's Guide to Lateral Thinking Skills* (2017). Builds on Pugh's (1991) concept-selection tradition and IDEO's DVF lens (Brown, 2009).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Teams routinely converged on the most familiar idea (high feasibility, low novelty) or the most exciting idea (high novelty, low feasibility). NUF forced explicit trade-off across all three, surfacing the under-considered axis and preventing pet-idea selection.

FIGURE 1 · NUF SCORING

N	U	F	Total
8	9	4	21
3	8	9	20
10	5	3	18
7	8	8	23

Figure 1. Scoring across all three axes prevents single-axis pet-idea selection. The total is the discipline.

HOW IT IS USED

After ideation, list candidate ideas as rows and score each on N, U, F (1–10). Compute weighted total per portfolio strategy. The discipline of forcing a number on each criterion is the value, not the precision.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use after divergent ideation, in stage-gate review meetings, in venture portfolio reviews, and when a team's natural bias is clearly skewing toward one of the three axes.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Innovation portfolio managers, R&D; directors, product leadership, and consulting teams running structured ideation engagements with corporate clients.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Compared with Pugh's (1991) classical concept-selection matrix (many criteria) and IDEO's three-lens DVF (Brown, 2009, qualitative), NUF's contribution is the simplicity of three numerical axes. Building on Saaty's (1980) AHP weighting tradition, it preserves rigour while remaining workshop-fast.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

- Dot Voting · Slibrary 5
- IDEO 3 Lenses of HCD · Slibrary 1
- Impact-Effort Matrix · Slibrary 5
- How-Now-Wow · Slibrary 5

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Sloane, P. (2017) *The Leader's Guide to Lateral Thinking Skills*. 3rd edn. London: Kogan Page.

Pugh, S. (1991) *Total Design: Integrated Methods for Successful Product Engineering*. Wokingham: Addison-Wesley.

Brown, T. (2009) *Change by Design*. New York: HarperBusiness.

Saaty, T.L. (1980) *The Analytic Hierarchy Process*. New York: McGraw-Hill.

Impact-Effort Matrix

SLIBRARY 5 · SHEET 3 / 5

2×2: high-impact, low-effort first — the Pareto filter

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Impact-Effort Matrix is a 2×2 prioritisation tool plotting candidate options by their estimated impact (vertical) against delivery effort (horizontal). Four quadrants — Quick Wins, Major Projects, Fill-Ins and Thankless Tasks — yield an immediate execution sequence. The method's power is making relative judgement visible, not absolute precision (Sibbet, 2010).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

A facilitation technique with roots in 1970s management consulting (BCG and McKinsey portfolio matrix lineage). Codified for innovation contexts in David Sibbet's *Visual Meetings* (2010) and adapted into agile prioritisation literature.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Long backlog lists were impossible to prioritise rationally — every item competed flat. Plotting items in 2D against impact and effort externalised the trade-off, made comparisons explicit, and produced an actionable sequence in minutes.

FIGURE 1 · IMPACT × EFFORT

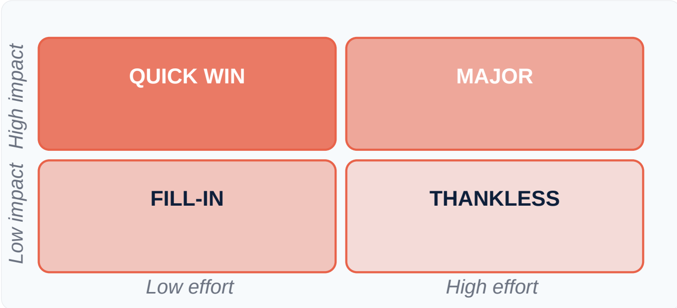

Figure 1. Quick Wins ship now; Thankless Tasks are deleted. The diagonal is the trade-off.

HOW IT IS USED

Draw axes on a wall. Place each candidate as a sticky in the appropriate quadrant by team consensus. Sequence: Quick Wins now, Major Projects planned, Fill-Ins backlog, Thankless Tasks deleted.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use after generating any backlog of options, in sprint planning, in feature triage, in roadmap prioritisation, and when a team needs a simple shared decision criterion.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product managers, agile teams, project managers, and innovation portfolio leads. Especially useful when stakeholders disagree on what is high-impact.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where the BCG growth-share matrix (1970) classified business units strategically and Eisenhower's urgency-importance matrix triaged personal tasks, the Impact-Effort Matrix's contribution is its directness on innovation candidates. Building on Pareto (1896), it operationalises the 80/20 rule in workshop time.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

2×2 Decision Matrix · Slibrary 5 | How-Now-Wow · Slibrary 5 | Dot Voting · Slibrary 5 | NUF Test · Slibrary 5

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Sibbet, D. (2010) *Visual Meetings*. Hoboken: Wiley.
Henderson, B. (1970) 'The Product Portfolio', *BCG Perspectives*. Boston: BCG.
Cohn, M. (2010) *Succeeding with Agile*. Upper Saddle River: Addison-Wesley.
Pareto, V. (1896) *Cours d'économie politique*. Lausanne: Rouge.

2×2 Decision Matrix

SLIBRARY 5 · SHEET 4 / 5

Pick two axes that matter — quadrants reveal the choice

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The 2×2 Decision Matrix is a generic prioritisation device in which the team identifies two independent criteria that genuinely discriminate between options and plots every option in two dimensions. The four resulting quadrants surface the decision visually: opposite-corner options dominate, mixed-quadrant options expose trade-offs that pure ranking would hide. The discipline lies in axis selection — picking criteria that are independent and decision-relevant (Roam, 2008).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

A staple of strategy consulting since BCG's growth-share matrix (Henderson, 1970), generalised for visual decision-making by Dan Roam in *The Back of the Napkin* (2008) and adapted to design and product contexts by IDEO and the d.school.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Single-axis ranking forced false trade-offs and lost dimensional information. Two axes preserved the decision's structure, made trade-offs explicit, and turned abstract debate into a visible, positional artefact the team could reason from.

FIGURE 1 · GENERIC 2×2

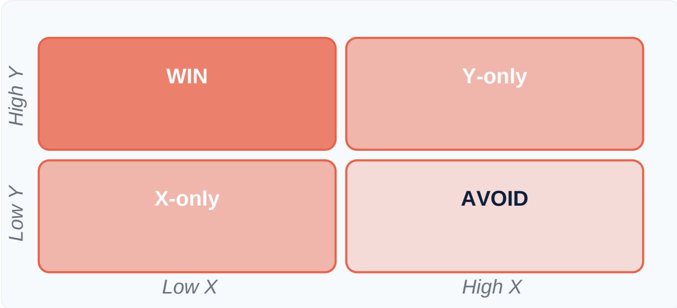

Figure 1. Axis selection is the design decision. Two truly discriminating criteria do most of the work.

HOW IT IS USED

Identify two criteria that genuinely matter and are independent of each other. Plot all options on the 2D field. Discuss outliers and clusters; the chosen action emerges from quadrant pattern, not absolute position.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use whenever a team faces multi-option decisions with visible trade-offs, in strategy workshops, in supplier selection, and when single-criterion ranking has produced unsatisfying results.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Strategy consultants, product managers, executive teams, and any decision-maker explaining a choice to stakeholders who need to see the reasoning.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Pugh's (1991) decision matrix used many criteria with weights and AHP (Saaty, 1980) used pairwise comparisons, the 2×2's contribution is radical simplification — two criteria, plotted visually. Building on Cartesian coordinate intuition, it makes complex trade-offs immediately legible.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Impact-Effort Matrix · Slibrary 5 | How-Now-Wow · Slibrary 5 | Possibility Quadrant · Slibrary 11 | NUF Test · Slibrary 5

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Roam, D. (2008) *The Back of the Napkin*. New York: Penguin.
Henderson, B. (1970) 'The Product Portfolio', *BCG Perspectives*. Boston: BCG.
Lowy, A. and Hood, P. (2004) *The Power of the 2×2 Matrix*. San Francisco: Jossey-Bass.
Saaty, T.L. (1980) *The Analytic Hierarchy Process*. New York: McGraw-Hill.

How-Now-Wow

SLIBRARY 5 · SHEET 5 / 5

Now (easy & ordinary) · How (hard & original) · Wow (the breakthrough)

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

How-Now-Wow is a 2×2 idea-classification matrix from *Creative Facilitation* (Byttebier, 2002) plotting ideas by feasibility (axis 1) and originality (axis 2). The four named quadrants — Now (easy, ordinary), How (hard, original), Wow (easy, original — the breakthrough), and Lame (hard, ordinary) — direct attention. The method privileges Wow ideas as portfolio targets while parking obvious-and-easy ideas in the Now bucket.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Igor Byttebier, COCD (Centre for the Development of Creative Thinking) Belgium, codified in his *Creative Facilitation* training materials and the COCD Box. Disseminated globally through Gray, Brown and Macanufo's *Gamestorming* (2010).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Teams converged on either ordinary-and-easy ideas (high pass rate, low value) or original-but-impractical ideas (impressive in workshops, never built). How-Now-Wow's named quadrants gave teams permission to ship Now ideas immediately while protecting Wow ideas from premature feasibility-killing.

FIGURE 1 · HOW-NOW-WOW

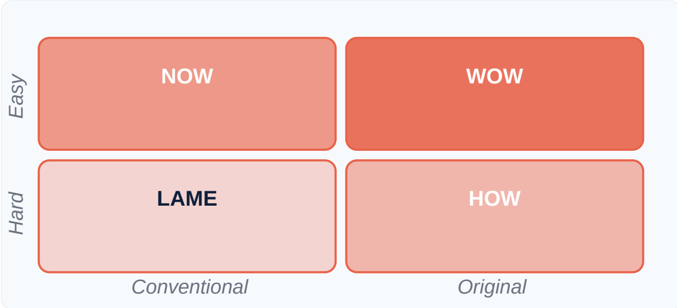

Figure 1. Wow is protected by name; Now ships fast; Lame is deleted. The quadrants are the portfolio.

HOW IT IS USED

Plot each idea on the matrix. Now ideas ship immediately. Wow ideas are protected for prototyping. How ideas are parked for further work or budgeted research. Lame ideas are deleted.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use as an ideation-convergence step, in innovation-portfolio review, when a team is over-rotating on either feasibility or novelty, and to communicate portfolio rationale to stakeholders.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Innovation facilitators, product portfolio managers, design coaches, and corporate-innovation teams managing balanced pipelines.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Compared with the generic Impact-Effort Matrix (business outcomes) and NUF Test (Sloane, 2017, three-axis), How-Now-Wow's contribution is the named, memorable quadrants and the explicit portfolio logic. Byttebier's design choice — protecting Wow by name — counters teams' default conservatism.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

- Impact-Effort Matrix · Slibrary 5
- NUF Test · Slibrary 5
- 2×2 Decision Matrix · Slibrary 5
- Possibility Quadrant · Slibrary 11

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Byttebier, I. (2002) *Creativiteit Hoe? Zo!*. Tielt: Lannoo.
Gray, D., Brown, S. and Macanufo, J. (2010) *Gamestorming*. Sebastopol: O'Reilly.
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Csikszentmihalyi, M. (1996) *Creativity*. New York: HarperCollins.

Google Design Sprint

SLIBRARY 6 · SHEET 1 / 5

Mon Map · Tue Sketch · Wed Decide · Thu Prototype · Fri Test

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Google Design Sprint is a five-day, time-boxed format compressing months of strategy debate into a single working week. Monday: map the problem. Tuesday: sketch competing solutions. Wednesday: decide on one. Thursday: build a realistic prototype. Friday: test with five real users. The method's discipline lies in the calendar — five named days, one named output per day — making the format unmissable to executives and replicable across organisations (Knapp, Zeratsky and Kowitz, 2016).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Jake Knapp at Google Ventures (now GV), refined across more than 100 sprints with Google portfolio companies, codified in *Sprint* (Knapp, Zeratsky and Kowitz, 2016) — the most-sold design-thinking book of the 2010s.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

GV portfolio companies repeatedly delayed launch decisions for months while debating directions. Knapp engineered a five-day forcing function that produced a tested, evidence-based answer fast enough for executive decision-making — replacing strategy-by-committee with structured experiment.

FIGURE 1 · FIVE SPRINT DAYS

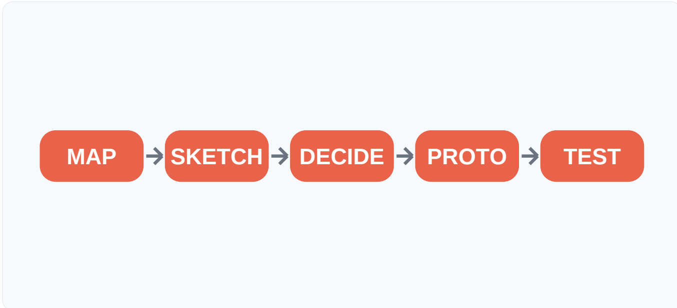

Figure 1. One named output per day; the calendar is the design. Five days replaces five months of debate.

HOW IT IS USED

Five consecutive days, one team, one room, one decision. Each day has a named output (map, sketches, storyboard, prototype, test report). Day Five testing with five real users decides whether to ship, iterate or kill.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use when a team has been stuck on a strategy decision, when a new feature or product must be evaluated before commitment, and when leadership needs evidence-based input within a week.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product teams, startup founders (especially GV portfolio), corporate-innovation teams, and design facilitators. Adopted by Slack, IDEO, Lego, BMW, and dozens of public-sector innovation labs.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where the Stanford d.school's (2010) generic 5-stage process and IDEO's HCD process were open-ended, the Sprint's contribution is the rigid 5-day calendar with named daily outputs. Building on Toyota's (Ohno, 1988) takt-time discipline, it transports a manufacturing rhythm to creative work.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

- Crazy 8s · Slibrary 4
- GV Sprint 2.0 · Slibrary 6
- Lightning Decision Jam · Slibrary 6
- Stanford d.school 5-Stage Process · Slibrary 1

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Knapp, J., Zeratsky, J. and Kowitz, B. (2016) *Sprint*. New York: Simon & Schuster.
Banfield, R., Lombardo, C.T. and Wax, T. (2015) *Design Sprint*. Sebastopol: O'Reilly.
Lewrick, M., Link, P. and Leifer, L. (2018) *The Design Thinking Playbook*. Hoboken: Wiley.
Ohno, T. (1988) *Toyota Production System*. Cambridge, MA: Productivity Press.

GV Sprint 2.0

SLIBRARY 6 · SHEET 2 / 5

Jake Knapp's 4-day compressed version — same arc, tighter

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

GV Sprint 2.0 is Jake Knapp's 2019 redesign of the original 5-day format compressed to four working days, merging the Monday Map and Tuesday Sketch days and tightening the Wednesday decision. The 2.0 version reflects accumulated facilitator learning that the original was fastest when participants pre-read the brief. The four-day version preserves the Friday user-test discipline while reducing executive sponsorship cost (Knapp, 2019).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Jake Knapp, in 2019, building on five years of post-publication facilitation experience and feedback from over 1,000 sprints run worldwide. Documented in updated *Sprint* resources and Knapp's blog publications.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Five-day sprints required week-long executive commitment — a barrier in scale-ups and corporates where senior teams could not block five consecutive days. Knapp tested whether four days could produce the same decision quality and found pre-work bridged the gap.

FIGURE 1 · FOUR-DAY FORMAT

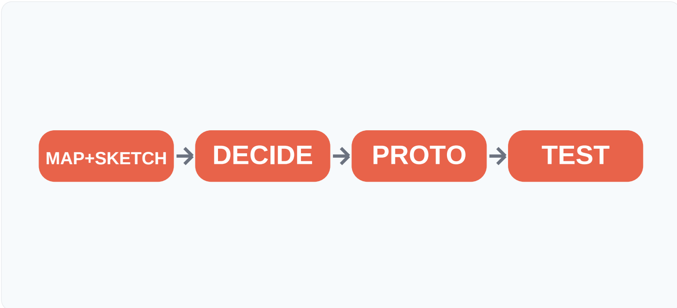

Figure 1. Day 1 absorbs the original Monday's lecture into pre-work. The sprint loses a day, not a discipline.

HOW IT IS USED

Day 1: combined map-and-sketch. Day 2: decide and storyboard. Day 3: prototype. Day 4: user test. Pre-reading is mandatory; the original Monday's lecture content moves to async preparation.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use when full 5-day sprint is logistically blocked, when teams have done a sprint before (so pre-work is realistic), and in scaled deployments where multiple sprints run in parallel.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Experienced sprint facilitators, scale-up product teams, internal innovation labs running multiple parallel sprints, and consultancies past first-time DT engagements.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Compared with the original GV Sprint (Knapp et al., 2016, 5 days), the 2.0 contribution is async pre-work plus a merged map-sketch day. Building on agile's increment-and-iterate principle (Beck et al., 2001) applied to facilitation methodology itself, the 2.0 version is faster without losing decision quality.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

- Google Design Sprint · Slibrary 6
- Lightning Decision Jam · Slibrary 6
- Sprint Retrospective · Slibrary 6
- Crazy 8s · Slibrary 4

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Knapp, J. (2019) 'The 2019 Sprint Update: A Faster, Tighter Process', *Medium / Jake Knapp*.
Knapp, J., Zeratsky, J. and Kowitz, B. (2016) *Sprint*. New York: Simon & Schuster.
Banfield, R., Lombardo, C.T. and Wax, T. (2015) *Design Sprint*. Sebastopol: O'Reilly.
Beck, K. et al. (2001) *Manifesto for Agile Software Development*. Available at: agilemanifesto.org.

Idea Speed-Dating

SLIBRARY 6 · SHEET 3 / 5

5-minute rounds to pitch and refine ideas with successive strangers

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Idea Speed-Dating is a high-tempo refinement format in which presenters pitch a single idea to a series of 5-minute partners, receiving structured feedback in each round before reformulating for the next. By round five, the pitch has been refined against five independent perspectives — surfacing parts that resonate universally, assumptions partners challenged repeatedly, and framings that worked best in different audiences (Brown, 2009; Liedtka and Ogilvie, 2011).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

A facilitation pattern that emerged in startup-pitch coaching contexts in the 2000s, codified in IDEO's facilitation playbook and elaborated by Liedtka and Ogilvie (2011). Variations are taught at d.school, MIT Media Lab, and most accelerator programmes.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Single-pitch feedback was sample-size-of-one and prone to one strong opinion shaping the idea. Rotating through five partners produced statistically more reliable signal — patterns that emerged across rounds were real; one-off objections could be discounted.

FIGURE 1 · FIVE-ROUND ROTATION

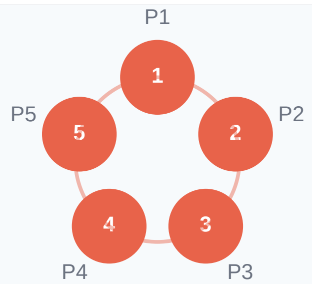

Figure 1. Five rotations × five minutes = five distinct feedback signals. Patterns across rounds are real signal.

HOW IT IS USED

Set up two parallel rows. Each pair has 5 minutes (3-minute pitch, 2-minute feedback). Then one row rotates one seat. Five rounds = five distinct partners. After the loop, each pitcher consolidates the signal and reformulates.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use mid-workshop after initial ideation, in accelerator programmes between mentor sessions, in pitch preparation for funding events, and in capstone-presentation rehearsals.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Accelerator programme directors, pitch coaches, MBA capstone facilitators, and startup teams preparing for investor pitches who need rapid structured feedback.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where one-on-one mentoring (Drucker, 1985) gave deep but slow feedback and panel feedback gave fast but unfiltered signal, Speed-Dating's contribution is the rotational structure that produces statistically usable feedback at workshop pace, drawing on speed-dating's compression discipline.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

- Lightning Decision Jam · Slibrary 6
- Sprint Retrospective · Slibrary 6
- Distill-Decompose-Prioritise · Slibrary 22
- Discovery Interviews · Slibrary 16

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Liedtka, J. and Ogilvie, T. (2011) *Designing for Growth*. New York: Columbia Business School Publishing.
Brown, T. (2009) *Change by Design*. New York: HarperBusiness.
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Drucker, P.F. (1985) *Innovation and Entrepreneurship*. New York: Harper & Row.

Lightning Decision Jam

SLIBRARY 6 · SHEET 4 / 5

AJ&Smart's 60-min format for turning any complaint into an experiment

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

Lightning Decision Jam (LDJ) is a 60-minute structured format developed by AJ&Smart; that takes a team from undirected complaint to specific testable experiment in nine timed steps. Participants surface problems silently (5 min), prioritise via dot voting (5 min), reframe as challenges (5 min), generate solutions silently (10 min), prioritise solutions (5 min), pick winners (5 min), and define experiments (15 min). The format compresses a typical workshop arc into one hour (Courtney, 2018).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Jonathan Courtney and the AJ&Smart; team (Berlin), drawing on their experience running hundreds of Google Design Sprints. Documented in *Lightning Decision Jam: A 60-Minute Workshop That Replaces 6 Hours of Meetings* (Courtney, 2018).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Most workshops produced lots of discussion and few committed actions. AJ&Smart; engineered LDJ as a forcing function that always ends with concrete experiments — converting collective complaining into individual ownership in under an hour.

FIGURE 1 · NINE STEPS IN 60 MIN

Figure 1. Six visible phases (nine timed steps); the experiment is the only acceptable end-state.

HOW IT IS USED

Walk all nine steps with strict timers (5–15 min each). The silent-write/dot-vote rhythm prevents discussion-spirals. The forcing question "What experiment will you run by Friday?" closes the session.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use in retrospectives, in ad-hoc problem-solving meetings, when a team is venting unproductively, and when a single-day workshop has a 1-hour slot for action-planning.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Agile coaches, scrum masters, product teams, and managers running cross-functional problem-solving sessions. Increasingly used by HR for team-health interventions.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where the full Google Design Sprint (Knapp, 2016) compressed strategy into a week, LDJ's contribution is to compress action-planning into an hour. Building on Liberating Structures (Lipmanowicz and McCandless, 2014) and Knapp's note-and-vote pattern, LDJ converts complaint into experiment with workshop-sized friction.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Sprint Retrospective · Slibrary 6 | Google Design Sprint · Slibrary 6 | GV Sprint 2.0 · Slibrary 6 | Dot Voting · Slibrary 5

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Courtney, J. (2018) *Lightning Decision Jam: A Workshop in 60 Minutes*. Berlin: AJ&Smart; Publishing.
Knapp, J., Zeratsky, J. and Kowitz, B. (2016) *Sprint*. New York: Simon & Schuster.
Lipmanowicz, H. and McCandless, K. (2014) *The Surprising Power of Liberating Structures*. Seattle: Liberating Structures Press.
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Sprint Retrospective

SLIBRARY 6 · SHEET 5 / 5

Worked · Didn't · Try next — the habit that compounds sprint quality

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Sprint Retrospective is a structured end-of-cycle reflection in which the team answers three questions: what worked, what didn't, what to try next. Originally a Scrum ceremony (Schwaber and Sutherland, 2020), the discipline has been imported into design sprints, hackathons and leadership offsites. The retrospective is the meta-practice that compounds sprint quality over time — without it, teams repeat the same mistakes per sprint indefinitely (Derby and Larsen, 2006).

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Codified in Ken Schwaber and Jeff Sutherland's *Scrum Guide* (2002–present); operationalised for teams by Esther Derby and Diana Larsen in *Agile Retrospectives* (2006). Roots in Toyota's *hansei* reflection practice (Liker, 2004).

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Teams completed cycles and immediately started new ones, never extracting learning. Schwaber and Sutherland made the retrospective a non-negotiable Scrum ceremony, and Derby and Larsen gave it a five-stage structure that made it actually generative.

FIGURE 1 · THREE QUESTIONS

WORKED → keep

DIDN'T → stop

TRY NEXT → experiment

Figure 1. Three questions, repeated every cycle, are the meta-practice that compounds team quality.

HOW IT IS USED

After each sprint or cycle, run a 60–90 minute facilitated session: set stage, gather data (worked/didn't), generate insights, decide actions, close. The decided actions become improvements applied in the next cycle.

WHEN IT IS USED

Use at the end of every sprint, every project phase, every quarter, and after major incidents or releases. Skip it once and the team starts repeating mistakes.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Scrum masters, agile coaches, design-sprint facilitators, project managers, and team leads in any iterative context. Increasingly mandated in venture and accelerator contexts.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Where Toyota's *hansei* (Liker, 2004) was a manufacturing reflection practice and Kolb's (1984) experiential learning cycle was an individual model, the retrospective's contribution is the team-level meta-cycle that catches process failures alongside product failures. Derby and Larsen (2006) gave it the operational structure that made it work in practice.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

- Lightning Decision Jam · Slibrary 6
- Pre-Mortem · Slibrary 11
- Build-Measure-Learn · Slibrary 15
- Validation Experiments · Slibrary 16

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Schwaber, K. and Sutherland, J. (2020) *The Scrum Guide*. Available at: scrumguides.org.

Derby, E. and Larsen, D. (2006) *Agile Retrospectives: Making Good Teams Great*. Raleigh: Pragmatic Bookshelf.

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